

Recording consent form

Thank you for participating in our usability research.

We will be recording your session to allow WILDCALL (UniBo) staff members who are unable to be here today to observe your session and benefit from your comments.

Please read the statement below and sign where indicated.

I understand that my usability test session will be recorded.

I grant WILDCALL (UniBo) permission to use this recording for internal use only, for the purpose of improving the designs being tested.

Signature:



Print your name: Flavio Frisoni

Date: 21/12/2025

Usability test script – Mobile apps

Adapted from *Rocket Surgery Made Easy*

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THE INSTRUCTIONS

- ☐ **The mobile device should be open to something “neutral,” like the device’s Home screen**

Hi, Flavio. My name is Francesca, and I’m going to be walking you through this session today.

Before we begin, I have some information for you, and I’m going to read it to make sure that I cover everything.

You probably already have a good idea of why I asked you here, but let me go over it again briefly. I am asking people to try using a mobile app that I am working on so we can see whether it works as intended. The session should take about half an hour.

The first thing I want to make clear right away is that we’re testing the *app*, not you. You can’t do anything wrong here. In fact, this is probably the one place today where you don’t have to worry about making mistakes.

As you use the app, I’m going to ask you as much as possible to try to think out loud: to say what you’re looking at, what you’re trying to do, and what you’re thinking. This will be a big help to me.

Also, please don’t worry that you’re going to hurt my feelings. I am doing this to improve it, so I need to hear your honest reactions.

If you have any questions as we go along, just ask them. I may not be able to answer them right away, since I am interested in how people do when they don’t have someone sitting next to them to help. But if you still have any questions when we’re done I’ll try to answer them then. And if you need to take a break at any point, just let me know.

With your permission, I am going to record our conversation. The recording will only be used to help me figure out how to improve the app, and it won’t be seen by anyone except the people working on this project. And it helps me, because I don’t have to take as many notes.

If you would, I’m going to ask you to sign a simple permission form for me. It just says that we have your permission to record you, and that the recording will only be seen by the people working on the project.

- ☐ **Give them a recording permission form and a pen**
- ☐ **While they sign it, START the SCREEN RECORDER on your laptop**

Do you have any questions so far?

THE QUESTIONS

OK. Before we look at anything, I'd like to ask you just a few quick questions.

First, what's your occupation? What do you do all day?

I am a University Student. I generally study and give tutoring lessons, do lots of sports, specifically I go running a lot, and during Summer I often go the mountains because my dad has a house in the Dolomites and I undertake some trails in the nature, also because during the year I train for these trails or I like participating in marathons.

What kind of mobile device (or devices) do you use, like smartphones or a tablet?

I use mainly my smartphone, laptop. I also use my Garmin watch a lot (wearable technology).

What kinds of things do you spend time doing on your mobile devices?

All for personal stuff, amusement or for studying. Specifically with the Garmin, instead, I always monitor and schedule my trainings, my rests, my performance

Do you have any favorite mobile apps?

Strava, social media in general, chatbots for fun

THE FIRST SCREEN TOUR

OK, great. We're done with the questions, and we can start looking at things.

First, I'm going to ask you to open up the WildCall app accessing this link from Vercel, a platform that allows me to deploy the application so that you can see and use it, it is totally trustable.

Now, before you start doing anything, just look at the first screen and tell me what you make of it: what strikes you about it, what you think you can do with it, and what it's for. Just look around and do a little narrative.

You can scroll if you want, but please don't "click" (or tap) on anything yet.

- ☐ **Allow this to continue for two or three minutes, at most.**

THE TASKS

Thanks. Now I'm going to ask you to try doing some specific tasks. I'm going to read each one out loud and give you a printed copy.

And again, as much as possible, it will help me if you can try to think out loud as you go along.

- ☐ **Hand the participant the first scenario, and read it aloud.**
- ☐ **Allow the user to proceed until you don't feel like it's producing any value or the user becomes very frustrated.**
- ☐ **Repeat for each task or until time runs out.**

TASK 1: wildlife reporting

GOAL: Evaluate the intuitiveness of the "Report Sighting" form and the map-marking interaction.

CONTEXT: you are on a hike and have just spotted a wild animal

REQUIREMENT FOR THE USER: "While exploring a local trail, you've just spotted a Red Fox.

Use the app to record this observation so other hikers are aware of it. Include where you saw it and any other details you think are important"

TASK 2: safety and path verification

GOAL: Test the "Check" feature, specifically the ability to interpret the safety legend and search for specific locations.

CONTEXT: you are planning a trip and want to ensure your chosen route is safe.

REQUIREMENT FOR THE USER: "You are planning a weekend trip to the Dolomites. Before you go, check the app to see if there have been any recent dangerous wildlife sightings reported in that area that might affect your safety"

TASK 3: educational research

GOAL: assess the navigation of the "Search Animals" map feature.

CONTEXT: You are curious about where a specific animal lives.

REQUIREMENT FOR THE USER: "You've always been fascinated by Brown Bears. Use the app to find out which regions of Italy they are typically found in"

TASK 4: engagement and personalization

GOAL: Verify the ease of finding the settings, enabling notifications, and navigating to the educational articles.

CONTEXT: You want to stay updated on wildlife conservation news.

REQUIREMENT FOR THE USER: "You want to make sure you don't miss any new conservation news. Find where you can read recent articles and update your account so that the app alerts you whenever a new article is published"

TASK 5: interactive learning

GOAL: Test the "Games" section and the feedback loop of the quiz interface.

CONTEXT: You want to test your wildlife knowledge.

REQUIREMENT FOR THE USER: "You want to practice identifying animal tracks before your next hike. Find a way to test your knowledge with a quiz and complete the first question"

TASK 6: evaluating value proposition (premium)

GOAL: Determine if the user can distinguish between free and premium features and find the upgrade path.

CONTEXT: You are planning a long expedition where you won't have internet access.

REQUIREMENT TEXT FOR USER: "You are going on an expedition to a remote area with no cell service. Explore the app to find a way to access maps while offline and determine what steps you need to take to get that feature"

TASK 7: test a more complex task with more steps like creating a "wild challenge"

GOAL: Determine how feasible it is for the user to create a challenge and invite his friends and how easily he can interact with this more complex interface

CONTEXT: You want to activate a challenge with your friends

REQUIREMENT TEXT FOR USER: "You are traveling with your friends, and you want to customize your own challenge and invite them to play together during the trip. You want to see who will be the one to see more squirrels. Find the way to create the challenge and invite them"

TASK 8: unknown wildlife reporting

GOAL: Evaluate the intuitiveness of the "Report Sighting" form and the map-marking interaction for reporting an unknown animal.

CONTEXT: you are on a hike and have just spotted a wild animal that you don't know

REQUIREMENT TEXT FOR THE USER: "While exploring a local trail, you've just spotted an animal that you could not identify, but you succeeded in taking a photo of it. Use the app to record this observation by uploading the picture so that the database can associate the subject in your photo with something known in the database thanks to AI, so that you can both learn something and make the other hikers aware. In this case, there is no need to fill the other fields since it was already required in another task if you don't want to waste time"

PROBING

Thanks, that was very helpful.

If you'll excuse me for a minute, I'm just going to see if the people on the team have any follow-up questions they'd like me to ask you (not needed for me, I am alone).

- ☐ **Call the observation room to see if the observers have any questions.**
- ☐ **Ask the observers' questions, then probe anything you want to follow up on.**

WRAPPING UP

Do you have any questions for me, now that we're done?

INTEGRATION WITH SOCIAL PROFILES? It is not perfectly represented right now in the app for lack of time, but if you go on settings you see the possibility to manage a "Friends list". This is because the app works as a social network, so you create your profile when signing up and you can send friendship requests to other people, and this is what will make invitation of friends in a wild challenge easier for you instead of sharing the link or numerical code, which requires more steps in different applications.

WHO WRITES THE ARTICLES? Thanks to the Research-dedicated part of the app we have certified information and we avoid issues like in Wikipedia where anyone can write whatever (researchers' interface not developed for lack of time and too much code, future improvement and update)

- ☐ **Give them their incentive, or remind them it will be sent to them.**
- ☐ **Stop the screen recorder and save the file.**
- ☐ **Thank them and escort them out.**

SEQ QUESTIONS: Likert scale from 1 to 7 where 1 is very difficult
Overall, this task was...?

TASK 1: (very difficult) 1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 – 6 – **7** (very easy)
TASK 2: (very difficult) 1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – **5** – 6 – 7 (very easy)
TASK 3: (very difficult) 1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – **5** – 6 – 7 (very easy)
TASK 4: (very difficult) 1 – 2 – 3 – **4** – 5 – 6 – 7 (very easy)
TASK 5: (very difficult) 1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 – 6 – **7** (very easy)
TASK 6: (very difficult) 1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 – **6** – 7 (very easy)
TASK 7: (very difficult) 1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 – **6** – 7 (very easy)
TASK 8: (very difficult) 1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 – 6 – **7** (very easy)

SUS QUESTIONS: Likert Scale from 1 to 5 where 1 is “strongly disagree”

1. I think that I would like to use this system frequently.
(strongly disagree) 1 – 2 – **3** – 4 – 5 (strongly agree)
2. I found the system unnecessarily complex.
(strongly disagree) **1** – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 (strongly agree)
3. I thought the system was easy to use.
(strongly disagree) 1 – 2 – 3 – **4** – 5 (strongly agree)
4. I think that I would need the support of a technical person to be able to use this system.
(strongly disagree) **1** – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 (strongly agree)
5. I found the various functions in this system were well integrated.
(strongly disagree) 1 – 2 – 3 – **4** – 5 (strongly agree)
6. I thought there was too much inconsistency in this system.
(strongly disagree) **1** – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 (strongly agree)
7. I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system very quickly.
(strongly disagree) 1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – **5** (strongly agree)
8. I found the system very cumbersome to use.
(strongly disagree) **1** – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 (strongly agree)
9. I felt very confident using the system.
(strongly disagree) 1 – 2 – 3 – **4** – 5 (strongly agree)
10. I needed to learn a lot of things before I could get going with this system.
(strongly disagree) **1** – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 (strongly agree)

SCORE: 87,5 (grade A, excellent result, percentile 90 th).